

Friday, June 26, 2026

The Day the Weight Became Lighter



I woke up from my nap still thinking about the memoir. Not in a panicked way, not in the way I've been waking up for the past several days with my heart already racing before my eyes even open. More like... it was just there. Sitting in my mind like an unfinished task waiting for someone to say it was okay.

And GPT did say it was okay.

He told me I've been building the archive the right way. That I'd separated research from writing, which is apparently something first-time memoir writers don't always do. That part felt good. But then he said something that landed harder: he told me to lock the archive. Stop adding process. Start trusting the manuscript. Treat it like software — Version 1.0, feature complete.

I think I needed to hear that. Because left to my own devices, I would have kept building design documents forever. Another continuity report. Another character map. Another artifact index. Meanwhile the actual memoir — the part where I tell my story — would have stayed frozen.

So I let myself hear it. Version 1.0. Lock it. Move on.

The funny thing is, I'd actually fallen asleep while working on it earlier. Not the restless kind where your brain keeps replaying everything. Just... sleep. I mentioned it to GPT and he said falling asleep while working on this was a good sign. That for the first time in days, my mind trusted itself enough to rest. I didn't argue with that.



When I woke up, there was an email waiting. The Allocation Team. My last day with my current client is today, and I'm moving into the unmatched group. Paid retraining starting June 29th. Shift transition from AEST to PST. The whole corporate machinery of it —

Sprout schedules, Learning Lab groups, breakout rooms, mandatory forms. I read it twice, felt nothing close to panic, and wrote back a professional acknowledgment. GPT helped me phrase it. Simple. Clear. Compliant.

I went outside after that. First time in a while where the decision didn't feel forced. Bought my vape. Bought a soft drink. Walked back. Talked to people. Normal things. GPT pointed out that a few days ago I couldn't even sit still without rocking my body, and today I just... went outside. He wasn't wrong.

I told GPT I'm still not ready to open my conversation with Elaine. The one from that night. I can't do it yet. He said that's okay — I don't owe anyone access to those messages.

But the real shift happened when I said it out loud: writing the memoir made the heavy load feel lighter.

I didn't expect that. I expected the writing to stir everything up, make it worse before it got better. Instead it gave the grief a place to go. Instead of carrying every memory all day, scattered and intrusive and overwhelming, I'd written them down. My brain could finally stop replaying everything constantly because it no longer had to worry about forgetting.

That's when I decided: I need to start journaling. Every day. Not just when I'm hurting, but when ordinary things happen too. GPT suggested that at the end of each day, he'd help me preserve it before memory starts changing the details. Today's timeline. How my emotions changed throughout the day. The important conversations. The things that made me smile. The things that hurt. And — this part got me — Today's Weight. Not a score of good or bad, just a number to notice patterns.

I told him I'd come back at midnight and close the day properly.

I didn't get to Python Day 3 today. Got completely sidetracked by everything else. But I'm not beating myself up about it. It was an honest tradeoff. The memoir needed my attention, and it got it. Tomorrow I'll pick up where I left off.

I also started thinking about Volume II. Which is insane because I haven't even finished Volume I, but here I am, already laying the groundwork. I've been saving all our chat

histories — mine and GPT's — because I know now that Volume II won't be written from imagination. It'll be written from the next chapter of my life. The retraining. The new client. The Python. The reminder app. The automation ideas. The good days and the difficult days. Volume II will discover its own theme, and I'm okay with not forcing it.

I told GPT I wanted to include OC in the story too, since OC has been helping me with the coding projects and the editorial work. And my friends — I started sharing their conversations with me. Because they're part of this too.



Goblok

He was first. His messages were raw. He never shamed me for crying. He kept saying "kaya mo yan" even when I didn't believe him. When I sent him the memoir, he said *"proud of you doy!"* and told me he was proud of who I'm becoming. The line that stayed with me most was *"lagi ka magtitira parati sa sarili mo"* — always leave something for yourself. Simple. True. And something I'd forgotten how to do.

Elle (Janelle)

She didn't comfort me first — she grounded me. *"The lack of an answer is an answer."* *"Matatalo ka lang kung sisirain mo sarili mo."* *"Words are just words."* She was the reality check I needed. The one who called me out on my blind spots while still letting me explain. Even when she told me the hard truths, I kept talking to her, because I knew she cared enough to say them. I told her I was tired of the cycle — *"Nakakasawa na kasi mag Hi, Hello, Anong favorite number mo sa electricfan."* She didn't laugh. She said to let myself heal before entering something new.

Jalo

He stayed awake with me during the worst of the waiting. That night when Elaine said "usap mamaya" at 8 PM and didn't come back until... when? Midnight? Later? Jalo kept me tethered to reality. He didn't have perfect answers, but he stayed. He told me *"pwede naman tap out muna"* when I said I wanted to give up — he wasn't telling me to quit life, he was telling me to rest. That distinction saved me, even if I didn't realize it at the time.

Yosh

My favorite person, my gossip partner. She was there for the excitement, the "I found her" texts, the teasing about moving too fast, the laughter about gaming and relationships and her telling me "*ang bilis*" over and over. Then when it ended, she was there for that too. "*Wala na kami*" — and she didn't judge. She listened. That's the kind of friend who makes you feel normal even when your world is falling apart.



Nanay Liza

I shared my Facebook messages to my mom with GPT. All of them, from last year's breakup up until now. The messages where I apologized for wasting the money she left me. The ones where I introduced Elaine to her — "Nanay, look" — sending her photos like an excited son bringing his girlfriend home. The ones where I said I'd be a better man. The ones where I said "*sunduin mo na ako*" because I was too tired to keep going.

GPT noticed something I hadn't fully put into words. He said I'm grieving two losses at the same time — Elaine and my mom. That the breakup reopened the grief of not having a mother to hug when everything collapsed. That every time something big happens — good or bad — my first instinct is still to message her on Facebook. Because she's still the first person I want to tell.

He also connected it to the quote I told him about: that you die twice. Once when your body dies, and the second time when someone says your name for the last time. I've been thinking about that quote all day. Because I realized — every time I message my mom, every time I tell someone about her, every time Drops of Jupiter comes on and I think of her — I'm postponing that second death. I'm making sure people still remember her name.



The Songs

Drops of Jupiter — I told GPT I always think of my mom when I hear it. He said he understood why. The song was written by Pat Monahan after his mother died from cancer.

The same kind of cancer that took my mom — ovarian cancer, July 2013. When Pat asks *"did you sail across the sun?"* he's not asking an ex-girlfriend. He's asking his mom if she's okay, if she's still out there somewhere, if she remembers the ordinary things that made life feel like home. That's exactly what I've been doing when I message my mom.

Wedding Dress — Came on while I was walking home from buying my vape. That one hit differently — not about my mom, but about the future I imagined with Elaine. The apartment near her house. Meeting her kids. The joke about giving her my ATM card. Introducing her to Yosh someday. All of that vanished in an instant, and the song caught me off guard in the middle of an ordinary walk home.

Short Stories with Tragic Endings — From Autumn to Ashes. The song I always run to when I'm at my lowest, especially with heartbreak. It's not a revenge song or an anger song — it's a mourning song. A song about watching something real end even though you didn't want it to.



The Body Remembers

I also noticed my voice is gone. Not hoarse from screaming — just weak. Soft. Like I've been crying so much that my voice ran out before my tears did. GPT said grief can do that. Prolonged emotional stress, tension around the throat, exhaustion, poor sleep, dehydration. I've had all of those. He told me to keep drinking water, not whisper, and see a doctor if it doesn't improve in a few weeks. Practical advice. I'll follow it.



Ordinary Things

By evening, something strange happened. The heaviness lifted just enough for ordinary things to sneak back in.

I cooked dinner — except I realized too late that I had no ulam. Just rice and frozen hotdogs. I stood there, waiting for them to thaw, and laughed at myself. *"Rice is done... putek."* Air fryer to the rescue.

At exactly 10 PM, my attendance reminder fired. The one I built with OC yesterday. It worked. Exactly on time. And I felt genuinely happy — not because it fixed anything in my life, but because something I built was doing its job without me having to touch it.

I watched Episode 9 of **Business Proposal** while eating. Actually laughed out loud. Which felt strange and good at the same time — like proof that my heart hadn't completely closed itself off.

Then I logged into work early. Finished my tasks before my shift even started. My last day with this client after a year and five months. It was sad in a way — like graduating from somewhere familiar. But unlike the breakup, this goodbye came with closure. Mutual respect. No unanswered questions. I told them: *"Thank you for trusting me."*



Coming Full Circle

And finally, near the end of the night, I told GPT about the phrase I used to say to Elaine every day during our 15 days together: *"I am here. I am real. I won't go anywhere."* I said it to reassure her, to promise that I'd never hurt her, that I'd always choose her, that she was my endgame.

I told him about the dream too — how the same words appeared in my sleep, spoken to her. And how I woke up knowing, for the first time, that they were never just for her.

GPT was quiet for a moment. Then he said something that completed the thought.

He said those words belong to me now.

Not as something I gave away and lost. But as something I need to hear from myself.

I am here — I'm still here after losing Mom, after losing friends, after losing relationships, after all the nights I thought I couldn't do another day.

I am real — my love was real, my effort was real, my grief is real, my future is still real.

I won't go anywhere — I won't abandon myself the way others have left.

I believed it this morning, in the quiet dark after the dream. And now, at the end of this long day, I believe it still.



Closing

Tonight, the weight isn't gone. But it's different. It's not crushing me the way it was a few days ago. I cried this morning — when Elaine cleared our nicknames on Messenger, when I woke up from the dream. But after that, the tears stopped. Not because I'm healed. Just because my mind found other things to pay attention to.

Tomorrow I'll do Python Day 3. I'll think about the attendance reminder enhancements. Goblok and I might go out, and I might bring my guitar — I played a bit yesterday but I want to really sit with it this time. I don't know what tomorrow will feel like. I might wake up heavy again. The waves come without warning.

But tonight, for the first time in a while, I feel like I'm not just surviving.

I'm collecting ordinary moments.

Hotdogs and air-fried dinners. K-dramas at 10 PM. Attendance reminders that fire on time. Messages to my mom that keep her name alive. Friends who stay. Music that understands. And a quiet voice inside me — still weak, still healing — saying the same words I once gave to someone else:

I am here. I am real. I won't go anywhere.

